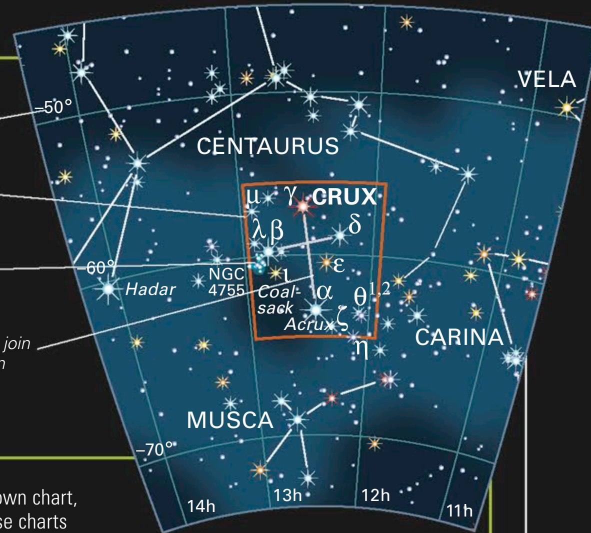
MAPPING THE SKY

The following pages divide the celestial sphere into six parts—two polar regions and four equatorial regions—which show the location of the 88 constellations. Each constellation is then profiled in the following section. Each entry places the constellation and its main features into the context of the rest of the sky.



VISIBILITY MAPS

The entry for each constellation contains a map showing the parts of the world from which it can be seen. The entire constellation can be seen from the area shaded black, part is visible from the area shaded gray, and it cannot be seen from the area shaded white. Exact latitudes for full visibility are given in the accompanying data set.

CONSTELLATION CHARTS

Each of the 88 constellation entries has its own chart, centered around the constellation area. These charts show all stars brighter than magnitude 6.5. Within the constellation borders, every star brighter than magnitude 5 is labeled. Deep-sky objects are represented by an icon.

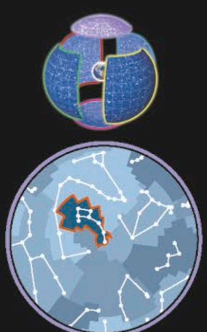
KEY TO STAR MAGNITUDES

-1.5–0 | 0–0.9 | 1.0–1.9 | 2.0–2.9 | 3.0–3.9 | 4.0–4.9 | 5.0–5.9 | 6.0–6.9

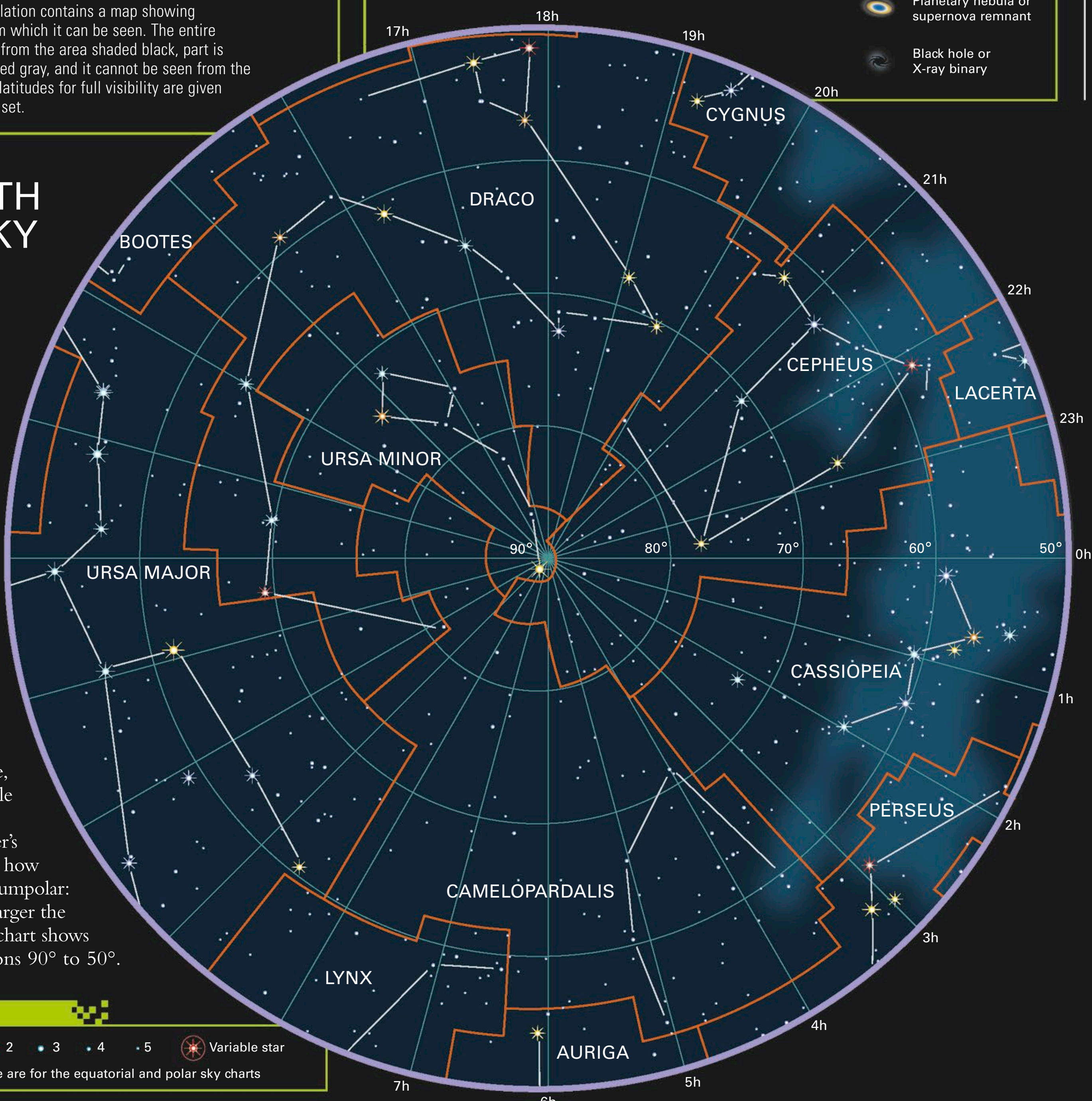
DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

- Galaxy
- Globular cluster
- Open cluster
- Diffuse nebula
- Planetary nebula or supernova remnant
- Black hole or X-ray binary

THE NORTH POLAR SKY



Almost in the center of this chart is the star Polaris, in Ursa Minor, which lies less than 1° from the north celestial pole. For observers in the Northern Hemisphere, the stars around the pole never set—they are circumpolar. The viewer's latitude will determine how much of the sky is circumpolar: the farther north, the larger the circumpolar area. This chart shows the sky from declinations 90° to 50°.



STAR MAGNITUDES

-1 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | Variable star

Star magnitudes shown here are for the equatorial and polar sky charts